

STATE OF NEW YORK

6253--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

March 7, 2025

Introduced by Sen. SKOUFIS -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Elections -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the election law, in relation to requiring state and county boards of elections to post sample ballots

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. Subdivision 3 of section 7-118 of the election law, as
2 separately amended by chapters 410 and 411 of the laws of 2019, is
3 amended to read as follows:

4 3. Sample ballots may be mailed by the board of elections to each
5 eligible voter at least three days before the [~~election, or in lieu~~
6 ~~thereof, a copy of such sample ballot may be published at least once~~
7 ~~within one week preceding the election in newspapers or on a website~~
8 ~~maintained by the board of elections~~] first day of early voting. Each
9 county board of elections shall transmit electronically in a format to
10 be determined by the state board of elections, as it is available, a
11 copy [~~of the candidate and contest information contained on each of its~~
12 ~~ballot styles~~] of a sample ballot for all election districts within that
13 county to the state board of elections. [~~The state board shall create a~~
14 ~~system to allow such information to be made publicly available via its~~
15 ~~website, as well as the website of any county board of elections, and in~~
16 ~~such a way as to be accessible with a computer screen reading program.~~]

17 § 2. Section 7-118 of the election law is amended by adding two new
18 subdivisions 3-a and 3-b to read as follows:

19 3-a. The state board of elections shall post a sample ballot for each
20 election district in the state on the board's website at least twelve
21 days prior to the first day of early voting. The board shall post such
22 sample ballots in a searchable database which allows voters to obtain
23 polling site information, voter district information and a sample ballot

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 that such voter shall be eligible to cast at the next election. Sample
2 ballots shall have an embedded security tool to prevent tampering and
3 printing of such sample ballots.

4 3-b. Each county board of elections may post a sample ballot for each
5 election district within that county at least twelve days prior to the
6 first day of early voting. A county board that posts such sample ballots
7 shall do so in a searchable database that allows voters to obtain poll-
8 ing site information and a sample ballot that such voter shall be eligi-
9 ble to cast in the next election. Such sample ballots shall have an
10 embedded security tool to prevent tampering and printing of such ballot.
11 Such county board of elections may also refer to the state board of
12 elections' website for such information to be delivered pursuant to
13 subdivision three-a of this section.

14 § 3. This act shall take effect on the ninetieth day after it shall
15 have become a law.